

RIBS AND PELVIS

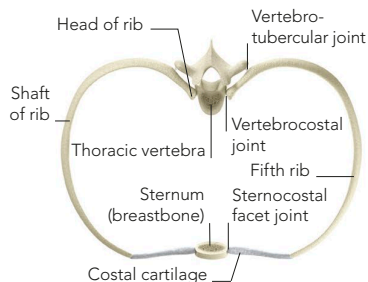
THE RIBS AND HIPBONE (PELVIS) GUARD VITAL CHEST AND ABDOMINAL ORGANS, AND DEMONSTRATE THE SKELETON'S FUNCTIONS OF SUPPORT AND PROTECTION. THE PELVIS PROVIDES SURFACES FOR ANCHORING THE HIP AND THIGH MUSCLES.

RIBCAGE

Most people have 12 pairs of ribs, but about 1 in 200 is born with one or more extra pairs. All ribs attach to the spinal column at the rear. The upper seven pairs of "true ribs" link directly to the breastbone (sternum) by their cartilage extensions (costal cartilages). The next two or three pairs of "false ribs" connect to the cartilages of the ribs above. The remaining "floating ribs" do not link to the sternum.

SHIELDING VITAL ORGANS

The ribs, thoracic spine at the rear, and breastbone (sternum) at the front shield vital internal organs such as the heart and lungs in the chest, and the liver and stomach in the upper abdomen.



ENCIRCLING RIBCAGE

Each rib links to its corresponding chest (thoracic) vertebra at two points. Flexible costal cartilage attaches ribs to the sternum, allowing the ribcage to change volume during breathing.

